



AI SEO Mastery Pro [Start ...

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Getting Started



SEO Foundation



Setting Up Your AI



Local SEO Foundations



How to Do Local AI SEO



The Google Business Pr...



Types of GBP

Verifying a GBP

GBP Description

GBP Services

GBP Categories

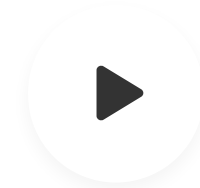
Making GBP Changes

Re-Theme'ing a GBP Catego...

Upcoming Holiday Hours

It Indatal Automated Calls

Types of GBP



1x

6 min

First, let's clear up any confusion about terminology. **Google Business Profiles (GBPs) were called Google My Business listings (GMBs) for about a decade.** You'll still hear many people refer to them as GMBs — they're exactly the same thing. Google simply rebranded them to Google Business Profiles a few years ago.

Why GBPs Matter for Local SEO

When someone performs a local search that triggers map results, the traffic distribution is eye-opening:

- **60-70%** of clicks go to one of the three GBPs in the map pack
- **5-10%** go to paid ads



Geotag Images

Get More Reviews

competing for a quarter of the total search traffic at most. The map results don't show business websites — they show Google Business Profiles. Without a GBP, you simply can't appear in this prime real estate.

[Prompt] Endless GBP Posts

Creating AI Content

Caleb's Internal Team's Cop...

Human Editing of AI Articles

Creating the Content Brief

Setting Up Claude Projects

Outbound Authority Links

Internal Anchor Text Guideli...

Generating Metadata

[Tool] Page Optimizer Pro

Building a Core 30 Web...

Overview

Prompt 0: Planning

Lovable HTML: NEEDED to ...

Prompt 1: Skeleton

Prompt 2: GBP Landing Pag...

Prompt 3: GBP Landing Pag...

Prompt 4: Secondary Categ...

Prompt 5: Core Service Pag...

 **Key Insight:** In local SEO, we're not trying to rank websites or URLs higher — we're trying to rank GBPs higher.

The Three Core Ranking Factors

1. Trust

"Trust" is SEO code for links from third-party websites. The more trustworthy and relevant these linking websites are, the better.

To build trust through local links:

- Join the Chamber of Commerce
- Sponsor local youth sports teams
- Support local nonprofit organizations
- Partner with community events (festivals, fundraisers, etc.)

The goal is to connect with anything hyper-local that has a powerful website in exchange for a link.

2. Relevance

We build relevance through content, specifically:

- **Geographic relevance** (content about your local area)
- **Topical relevance** (content about your services/industry)

Note that links to this relevance-building content serve a different purpose than trust-building links. These links help get your content indexed and recognized as quality content (not AI slop), but they're not the same powerful trust signals.

  **Related Lessons**

99+



Prompt 8: Technical SEO Im...

Walkthrough of Caleb's Build

3. Proximity

Starting Off-Site AI SEO ^

Introduction to Backlinking

External Anchor Text Guideli...

Local Authority Building

Searching for Link Opportun...

Monthly Google News Featu...

Blog Commenting

Social Signals

Optimizing for AI Syste... ^

How ChatGPT Makes Reco...

Data Source: ChatGPT VS. G...

How to Check Business Visi...

Proving Business Legitimacy

High Quality Mentions

Create Even More Schema

Review Diversification and S...

Reddit Optimization

Special Circumstances ^

YMYL-Niche Sites

The closer a searcher is to your GBP address, the easier it is to rank. This is why rank maps often show positions 1-3 near the business center, with rankings dropping off as distance increases.

However, proximity can be overcome! With enough trust and relevance, you can outrank competitors who are physically closer to the searcher. This is essentially what we're doing in a local SEO engagement – building trust and relevance to expand your ranking radius.

The Second Page Reality

Here's a favorite SEO joke: Where's the best place to hide a dead body? The second page of Google search results.

For local search with GBPs:

- Positions 1-3 appear in the map pack
- Position 4 is essentially the first result on the "second page"
- Being ranked #4 gets you roughly the same traffic as being ranked #80

⚠ Critical Point: If you can't do enough SEO to get into the top 3, save your money and don't do any at all. There's no benefit from moving from position 80 to position 5 – you'll get the same amount of traffic.

Types of Google Business Profiles

1. Single Location Business

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When to Use a Sitemap

NoFollow Attributes on Links

Hiding Content from Users

- GBP landing page (the website URL in the GBP) should point to the homepage

- Homepage is the most powerful URL on the domain, so it ranks faster

Disavowing Existing Backlin...

Non-Local SEO

Non-Local SEO Engagement...

Basic Site Structure

Search Console for Existing ...

Click Through Rate (CTR) A...

Identify Content with Existin...

Generate Topical Relevance

Keyword Research Philosop...

AI-Generate Keyword Variati...

Creating a Content Planner

AI-Rewriting Pages

2. Multi-Location Business

- One website, multiple GBPs
- Each GBP needs its own independent landing page
- Why? Each landing page must be optimized for its specific location:
 - Local business schema
 - Embedded GBP
 - Embedded reviews
 - City-specific content optimization

You can't optimize one landing page for multiple GBPs effectively.

 **Pro Tip:** If you inherit a multi-location client with all GBPs pointing to the homepage, run rank maps first! Only create new landing pages for locations that aren't ranking well. "Don't touch it if it's ranking" is a rule to live by in SEO.

3. Service Area Business (SAB)

Service area businesses require **30-50% more effort** to rank compared to businesses with visible addresses. In practical terms:

- Visible address business: \$3,000/month engagement
- Service area business: \$4,000-5,000/month for the same results

It's often less expensive to get office space and maintain a

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 **Critical:** Before taking on an SAB client, ensure both you and the client fully understand these downsides. The additional cost and effort required for SAB SEO can

make it an unwise investment compared to simply establishing a physical presence.